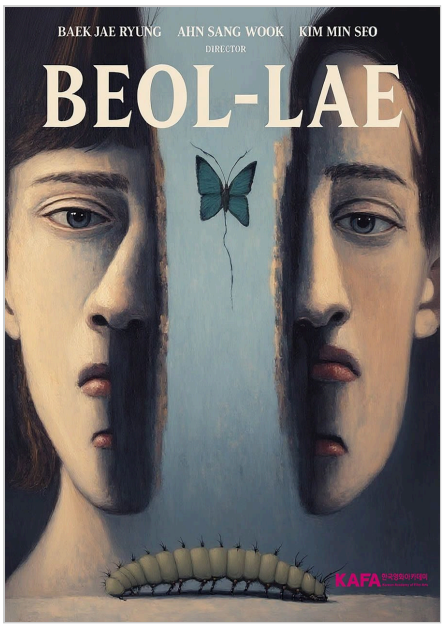
BEOL-LAE

벌레

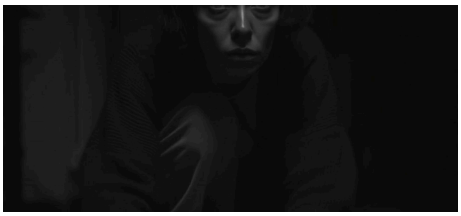


An unspoken grief crawls through a family's home — told entirely without dialogue.

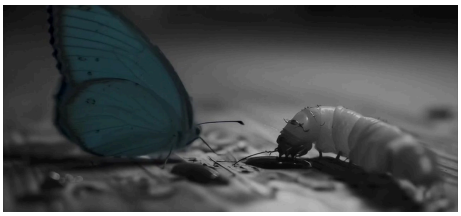
YEAR	2025
RUNTIME	8:29
GENRE	Drama · Psychological horror · AI short
SOURCE	Based on the short story by Ahn Sangwook
ASPECT RATIO	1.33:1 in 16:9
LANGUAGE	No dialogue (title cards in English)
SUBTITLES	—
COUNTRY	South Korea
STATUS	Selected by two Oscar-qualifying festivals

SYNOPSIS

A husband and wife live in a silence neither of them can break. Since their loss, the wife cleans the house again and again, and the husband has stopped trying to reach her. Then something begins to crawl — a single bug on the wall, then more, in the corners, under the floor, inside the walls. The more the couple holds back, the further the bugs spread, until they close in on the one person the two of them still have to protect. Told entirely without dialogue, Beol-lae ("bug" in Korean) turns a family's unspoken grief into an image.







FESTIVALS & SUPPORT

- 43rd Tehran International Short Film Festival — International Competition (2026, Oscar-qualifying)
- 20th Beirut Shorts International Film Festival — AI Innovation Competition (2026, Oscar-qualifying)

CREDITS

DIRECTED BY
Team Promptus (Ahn Sangwook, Baek Jaeryung, Kim Minseo)

ORIGINAL STORY & WRITER
Ahn Sangwook

ADAPTATION
Team Promptus

ART DESIGN / DI
Baek Jaeryung

VFX SUPERVISOR / MASTERING
Kim Minseo

PRODUCER
Ahn Sangwook

MADE AT
KAFA Advanced AI Filmmaking Course, 1st cohort (KOFIC)

AI DISCLOSURE

Built with generative AI by Team Promptus, using the uncanny texture of AI imagery as the language of a mind coming apart.